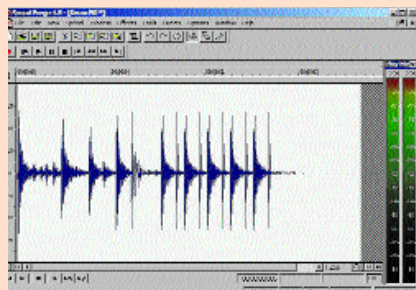


Editing with SoundForge 6.0

SoundForge can be used for editing, filtering, adding fade in and fade out effects, tweaking the frequency characteristics of the song, etc. We've used SoundForge 6.0 to illustrate the process of creating and working with a WAV file.

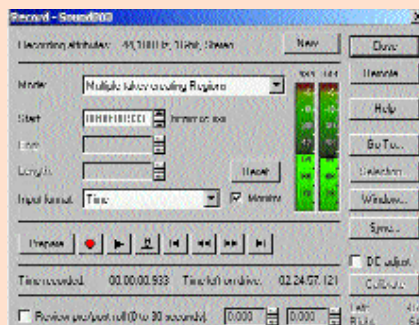


SoundForge: the Photoshop of audio editing

STEP 1 **Setting up SoundForge 6.0:** First, see if the recording attributes are set to 44,100 Hz, 16-bit, Stereo for CD-quality recordings. If not, click on the Record button in the toolbar. You could

choose to record at higher frequencies and then downsample the final output. Choose the recording device in the Preferences menu. Next to Mode, select Automatic Retake (automatically rewind). Check the Monitor box so that you can monitor the sound input levels.

STEP 2 **Recording:** Click on Prepare in the Record window. When the word 'Prepared' starts flashing, click on the Record button. The file will start recording. Click on

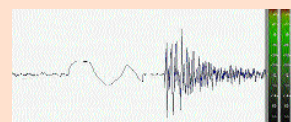


Set the Recording frequency to 44,100 Hz

the Stop button when you've finished recording.

Note: If the word 'Clip' appears above either of the meters, it means that the recording level was set too high and you will need to start over and re-digitise the file.

STEP 3 **Editing:** You can edit your audio track by using the Pencil tool. Here, you can 'carve' the response of your audio by simply drawing around the recorded wave file—play around with this



'Draw' with the Pencil tool to edit the wave file

and see the results. You can also use the noise gate from the Effects menu to filter out signals below the threshold you've defined. Voila! You've recorded your first WAV file! Now you can directly convert your track to an MP3 file or burn it onto an Audio CD.

will be able to produce sounds and rhythms good enough to record!

You will also need a multi-track editing software that can record several tracks and mix different recordings together. Look out for the number of tracks you can edit simultaneously—entry-level programs limit you to eight tracks, which could cause you to lose interest rather quickly. Good editing software also support plugins and editing features. Most importantly, the layout of the software should be user-friendly. Cakewalk SONAR is one such software that is not only powerful, but also feature-packed and easy to navigate. There are plenty of other software you can choose from to record and sequence your music such as Cubase, Cool Edit Pro, Vegas, Nuendo and SoundForge.

Distributing your music

Creating your music is only half the job. A lot depends on how well you make your sound heard. Marketing music usually involves marketing professionals, music companies and lots of funds. That leaves most of us searching for alternative means to spread the music. Techno savvy bands are increasingly using the Internet as a means of worldwide promotion of their



Sahil
FRONTMAN, DEMONIC
RESSURECTION

“I use either Nuendo, Cool Edit or N-track for recording; Fruity-Loops is good for drum and keyboard programming”

talent. The best avenue for all artists is **MP3.com**, which has a Pay-for-Play program that can earn you some money if you get a good number of hits.

Take the example of Demonic Resurrection, an extreme metal band known only in small circles in India. With the help of the Internet, the band has reached out to a considerably wider audience than they would have through conventional methods. They have been nominated for the best extreme metal act at **MP3.com** and are now being signed on by record labels from Brazil, Malaysia and Indonesia. “The Net has helped people across the world hear us. We have the maximum downloads compared to any Indian rock and metal act. We've received some 8,000 plus hits on **MP3.com** alone and some 2,000 downloads on Audio-galaxy,” says Sahil alias Demonstealer, founder of Demonic Resurrection.

Midival Punditz, an ambient fusion group with Asian Underground roots, use their official site and **MP3.com** to popularise their music. Even classical musicians like Chandrakant Sardeshmukh and Veena Sahasrabuddhe have garnered a huge fan following at **MP3.com** with 75,000 and 1,40,000 plays respectively. Bands like Parikrama have had over 500,000 views

on their homepage, and provide their MP3s free for download. Encode your music in MP3 format and let it be swapped around in the file sharing programs. Once viral marketing takes over and the popularity of your songs increases, the sky is the limit!

With all the ingredients for cooking the tastiest of digital audio tracks at your disposal, today it is easier than ever to create, fine-tune and distribute your opus—right from your home. “Technology has empowered the musician, helped him refine his skills, but it cannot make you a better musician,” says Rohit, the bassist of Pin Drop Violence. “Well, it can hide your flaws to some extent, but the basic thing is if you don't know how to cook, the best utensils won't make the food tastier.”

Need we say more?

SRIRAM SHARMA